

ENCLOSURE TO
FLEET MONTHLY
ROR – JUN 2017

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FOR JUN 2017

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol II, NP735 and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1.5 hrs.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

PART 1

1. **Describe a southerly cardinal buoy including light characteristics and the recommended navigable side. (NP735)(2.5)**

2. **Other than the special rules applicable to Allied naval ships, IRPCS is to be observed by ships in formation. True or False?(ATP 1G Vol II Art 141)(0.5)**

3. **Ships joining, leaving, approaching or passing through a formation must not hamper which units? (ATP 1G Vol II Art 141)(1)**

4. **What shape(s) and lights should towing vessels display (assuming length of tow over 200m)? (R24a)(3)**

5. Define safe speed and list the factors to be taken into account in determining safe speed by all vessels? **(R6a)(4)**

6. How should a vessel maintain a proper look-out?**(R5)(1)**

7. If radar is fitted and operational, how should it be used?**(R7b)(1)**

8. Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel or the owner, master or crew from what?**(R2a)(1)**

9. What does the term vessel not under command mean?**(R3f)(1)**

10. Describe the sound signals made by a vessel engaged in fishing at anchor in restricted visibility **(R35 c&d)(1)**

11. Indicate 6 methods of how a ship can indicate she is in distress.**(Annex IV)(3)**

12. Describe the lights displayed by a vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling when making way through the water **(R26c(i)(iii))(3)**

13. Where the size of a vessel engaged in diving operations makes it impracticable to exhibit all the lights prescribed for a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, which lights shall she exhibit instead? **(R27e(i))(1)**

14. When is a vessel deemed to be overtaking another? **(R13b)(1)**

15. When is a vessel deemed to be in sight of one another? **(R3k)(1)**

Part 2

You are the Navigating Officer of HMS DRAGON (length 152.4m) departing HMNB PORTSMOUTH Monday afternoon for a Capability Demonstration in London (West India Quay). The pilot is embarked, 2 tugs are in attendance and SSD is closed up. Fog is expected in the North Sea later on in the day. You have been given clearance by QHM to sail.

16. When will you be considered to be underway? **(R3i)(1)**

17. As you start making your way on the 179 leg, you notice a sailing vessel at Green 15 range 5c on steady bearing and does not appear to be taking any action. What could you do to indicate your concern? **(R34d)(1)**

18. In accordance with the Rules, what should the sailing vessel avoid doing? **(R9b)(1)**

19. What is your obligation should risk of collision exist? **(8f(iii), 18a)(1)**

20. As you go through the Round Tower gap, you notice a Container vessel at Green 45 range 4nm coming from Southampton. You anticipate there is possibility of close quarters around OSB and inform the pilot you intend to reduce speed as it is a crossing situation and you are the give way vessel. The pilot tells you that in order not to delay the next move, he will direct the vessel to wait for you to exit the narrow channel. Is this seamanlike and why?**(R1b)(2)**

21. You eventually pass Nab tower and SSD falls out. Your Navtrack takes you directly to the TSS. How are you meant to join a TSS?**(R10b(iii))(2)**

22. As your track crossed the SW traffic flow, what advise will you give the OOW before you depart the bridge for a cup of tea?**(R10f)(1)**

23. You spot a vessel engaged in fishing in the Traffic Separation Zone. Is she allowed in the zone? On what occasions are you permitted in the separation zone? **(R10e)(3)**

24. You detect one of the cross channel ferries at Red 30 at 5nm crossing the TSS with a CPA of 3c ahead. How is she meant to cross a TSS?**(R10c)(1)**

25. You deem risk of collision to exist. Who is the give way vessel?**(R15)(1)**

26. The situation continuous to build with no change in CPA, what is initial action is required of your ship?**(R17a(i))(1)**

27. As neither ship has taken action to avoid collision, when and how **may** the stand-on vessel take action?**(R17a(ii))(1)**

28. Just when the ferry passed at 5c astern, you notice another ferry at Green 50 at 2nm. The CO who came on the bridge for the previous incident asks if risk of collision exist with this ferry. How can this be determined noting her proximity and high speed?**(R7d)(2)**

29. On taking the second bearing, you notice the bearing is drawing slowly left but still not sure if risk of collision exist. What action does the Rule recommend if you need more time to make an assessment?**(R8e)(1)**

30. The ferry passes ahead at 5c and your next consideration is a MV proceeding at 8kts which you intend to overtake on the port side. What sound signals will you use and what response do you expect from her if she is in agreement?(**R34c**)(2)

31. You safely overtake the MV and safely cross the TSS to your holding box overnight. As you patrol your box, you notice visibility is reducing. When do the rules for restricted visibility apply?(**R19a**)(1)

32. What sound signals would you need to be making whilst patrolling your box?(**R35a**)(1)

33. You hear apparently forward of your beam 1 prolonged followed by 2 short blasts. You cannot determine if risk of collision exists. What should be your immediate action?(**R19e**)(2)

34. Your 200W reports a radar contact ahead at 3nm and you assess the contact ties in with the sound signal. What actions are you required to take and what must be avoided?(**R19d**)(2)

35. What type of contact could this be?(**R35c&d**)(3)

36. You suspect the contact is a sailing vessel underway (greater than 20m). What lights will you brief your fog lookout to look out for?(**R25a**)(1)

37. What additional lights may the sailing vessel display?(**R25c**)(1)

38. You brief the team to be on the lookout for the pilot vessel. What lights will they be looking out for if she is underway?(R29a(i)(ii))(2)

39. You notice an outbound Bulk carrier ahead of the ship with a CPA of 1c to starboard. You report it is a head on situation. How is this defined?(R14b)(1)

40. What action is required from both units?(R14a)(1)

41. The pilot informs you that a vessel constrained by her draught is heading outbound. What must you avoid doing?(R18d)(1)

42. You notice a small ferry at Green 45 lining up to cross to the other side. What does the Rule say about her actions; you can safely navigate only within the channel?(R9d)(1)

43. She starts to cross and CPA is steady and does not appear to be taking action so you sound 5 short blasts. In what manner did you expect her to act as required by the circumstances of the case?(R8f(i))(1)

44. The XO asks the YO to define a short blast. What answer will you expect if he was correct?(R32b)(1)

You eventually get alongside port side for a stand-easy followed by preparation for the Capability Demonstration.

Part 2 _____/40

TOTAL _____/65

PART 1

1. Describe a southerly cardinal buoy including light characteristics and the recommended navigable side. (NP735)(2.5)

Light: Q(6) + LFI or VQ(6) + LFI

Colour: Yellow over Black

Shape: Pillar or Spar

Topmark: Two Black Cones, apex downwards

Retroreflector: Yellow(on yellow part)/Blue (on black part) (Bonus mark)

Safe water to the South

2. Other than the special rules applicable to Allied naval ships, IRPCS is to be observed by ships in formation. True or False?(ATP 1G Art 141)(0.5)

True

3. Ships joining, leaving, approaching or passing through a formation must not hamper which units? (ATP 1G Art 141)(1)

General conduct of Ships in the presence of formed units. Ships joining, leaving, approaching or passing through a formation must not hamper ships already in formation.

4. What shape(s) and lights should towing vessels display (assuming length of tow over 200m)? (R24a)(3)

R24a. a power driven vessel when towing shall exhibit:

(i) instead of the light prescribed in Rule 23(a)(i) or (a)(ii), two masthead lights in a vertical line. When the length of the tow, measuring from the stern of the towing vessel to after the end of the tow, exceeds 200m, three such lights in a vertical line:

(ii) sidelights

(iii) stern lights

(iv) a towing light in vertical line above stern light

(v) when the length of the tow exceeds 200m, a diamond shape where it can best be seen

5. Define safe speed and list the factors to be taken into account in determining safe speed by all vessels? (R6a)(4)

R6. Every vessel shall at all times proceed at a safe speed so that she can take proper and effective action to avoid collision and be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions.

In determining a safe speed the following factors shall be amongst those taken into account:

a. The state of visibility

b. The traffic density including concentration of fishing vessels or any other vessels

c. The manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to the stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions

- d. At night the presence of background light such as from shore lights or from backscatter of her own lights
- e. The state of wind, sea and current and proximity of navigational hazards
- f. The draught in relation to the available depth of water

6. How should a vessel maintain a proper look-out?(R5)(1)

R5. Every vessel shall maintain a proper lookout by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision

7. If radar is fitted and operational, how should it be used?(R7b)(1)

R7b. Proper use shall be made of the radar equipment if fitted and operational including long range scanning to obtain early warning of the risk of collision and radar plotting or equivalent systematic observation of detected objects.

8. Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel or the owner, master or crew from what?(R2a)(1)

R2a. Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel or the owner, master or crew thereof, from the consequences of any neglect to comply with these Rules or the neglect of any precaution which may be required by the ordinary practice of seamen, or by the special circumstances of the case.

9. What does the term vessel not under command mean?(R3f)(1)

R3f. The term vessel not under command means a vessel which through some exceptional circumstance is unable to manoeuvre as required by these Rules and is therefore unable to keep out of the way of another vessel.

10. Describe the sound signals made by a vessel engaged in fishing at anchor in restricted visibility (R35 c&d)(1)

R35c. a vessel not under command, a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, a vessel constrained by her draught, a sailing vessel, a vessel engaged in fishing and a vessel engaged in towing or pushing another vessel shall, instead of the signals prescribed in paragraphs (a) or (b) or this Rule, sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts.

R35d. a vessel engaged in fishing, when at anchor, and a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre when carrying out her work at anchor, shall instead of the signals prescribe in paragraph (g) of this Rule sound the signals prescribed in paragraph (c) of this Rule.

11. Indicate 6 methods of how a ship can indicate she is in distress.**(Annex IV)(3)**

Any 6 from the list at IRPCS Annex IV

12. Describe the lights displayed by a vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling when making way through the water**(R26c(i)(iii))(3)**

R26c. a vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling shall exhibit:

(i) two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and the lower white ...

(iii) when making way through the water, in addition to the lights prescribed in this paragraph, sidelights and a sternlight

13. Where the size of a vessel engaged in diving operations makes it impracticable to exhibit all the lights prescribed for a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, which lights shall she exhibit instead?**(R27e(i))(1)**

R27e(i). Where the size of a vessel engaged in diving operations makes it impracticable to exhibit all the lights and shapes prescribed in paragraph (d) of this Rule, the following shall be exhibited:

(i) three all-round lights in a vertical line where they can best be seen. The highest and lowest of these lights shall be red and the middle light shall be white.

14. When is a vessel deemed to be overtaking another?**(R13b)(1)**

R13b. A vessel shall be deemed to be overtaking when coming up with another vessel from a direction more than 22.5 deg abaft her beam, that is, in such a position with reference to the vessel she is overtaking, that at night she would be able to see only the sternlight of that vessel but neither of her sidelights.

15. When is a vessel deemed to be in sight of one another?**(R3k)(1)**

R3k. Vessels shall be deemed to be in sight of one another only when one can be observed visually from the other

Part 1 ____/25

Part 2

You are the Navigating Officer of HMS DRAGON (length 152.4m) departing HMNB PORTSMOUTH Monday afternoon for a Capability Demonstration in London (West India Quay). The pilot is embarked, 2 tugs are in attendance and SSD is closed up. Fog is expected in the North Sea later on in the day. You have been given clearance by QHM to sail.

16. When will you be considered to be underway? **(R3i)(1)**

R3i. The word underway means a that a vessel is not at anchor, made fast to the shore, or aground.

17. As you start making your way on the 179 leg, you notice a sailing vessel at Green 15 range 5c on steady bearing and does not appear to be taking any action. What could you do to indicate your concern? **(R34d)(1)**

R34d. When vessels in sight of one another are approaching each other and from any cause either fails to understand the intentions or actions of the other, or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blast on the whistle. Such signal may be supplemented by light signal of at least five short and rapid flashes.

18. In accordance with the Rules, what should the sailing vessel avoid doing? **(R9b)(1)**

R9b. A vessel of less than 20m or a sailing vessel shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway.

19. What is your obligation should risk of collision exist? **(8f(iii), 18a)(1)**

R8f(iii). A vessel the passage of which is not to be impeded remains fully obliged to comply with the Rules of this part when the two vessels are approaching one another so as to involve risk of collision

R18. Except where Rules 9, 10 and 13 otherwise require:

(a) A power-driven vessel underway shall keep out of the way of:

(iv) a sailing vessel(1)

20. As you go through the Round Tower gap, you notice a Container vessel at Green 45 range 4nm coming from Southampton. You anticipate there is possibility of close quarters around OSB and inform the pilot you intend to reduce speed as it is a crossing situation and you are the give

way vessel. The pilot tells you that in order not to delay the next move, he will direct the vessel to wait for you to exit the narrow channel. Is this seamanlike and why?(R1b)(2)

No. It does not conform as closely as possible to the Rules (crossing situation) and it is not a special rule in this case.

R1b. Nothing in these Rules shall interfere with the operation of special rules made by an appropriate authority for roadsteads, harbours, rivers, lakes or inland waterways connected to the high seas and navigable by sea going vessels. Such special rules shall conform as closely as possible to these Rules.

21. You eventually pass Nab tower and SSD falls out. Your Navtrack takes you directly to the TSS. How are you meant to join a TSS?(R10b(iii))(2)

R10b(iii). ... normally join or leave a traffic lane at the termination of the lanes but when joining or leaving from either side shall do so at as small an angle to the general direction of traffic flow as practicable.

22. As your track crossed the SW traffic flow, what advise will you give the OOW before you depart the bridge for a cup of tea?(R10f)(1)

R10f. a vessel navigating in areas near the terminations of traffic separation schemes shall do so with particular caution.

23. You spot a vessel engaged in fishing in the Traffic Separation Zone. Is she allowed in the zone? On what occasions are you permitted in the separation zone? (R10e)(3)

Yes

R10e. A vessel other than a crossing vessel or a vessel joining or leaving a lane shall not normally enter a separation zone or cross a separation line except:

- (i) in cases of emergency to avoid immediate danger*
- (ii) to engage in fishing within a separation zone.*

24. You detect one of the cross channel ferries at Red 30 at 5nm crossing the TSS with a CPA of 3c ahead. How is she meant to cross a TSS?(R10c)(1)

R10c. a vessel shall so far as possible avoid crossing traffic lanes but if obliged to do so shall cross on a heading as nearly as practicable at right angles to the general direction of traffic flow.

25. You deem risk of collision to exist. Who is the give way vessel? (R15)(1)

R15. When two power driven vessels are crossing so as to involve risk of collision, the vessel which has the other on her starboard side shall keep out of the way and shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid crossing ahead of the other vessel.

26. The situation continuous to build with no change in CPA, what is initial action is required of your ship?(R17a(i))(1)

R17a(i). When one of two vessels is required to keep out of the way, the other shall keep her course and speed.

27. As neither ship has taken action to avoid collision, when and how **may** the stand-on vessel take action?(R17a(ii))(1)

R17a(ii). A vessel may, however take action to avoid collision by her manoeuvre alone, as soon as it becomes apparent to her that the vessel required to keep out of the way of the way is not taking appropriate action in compliance with these Rules

28. Just when the ferry passed at 5c astern, you notice another ferry at Green 50 at 2nm. The CO who came on the bridge for the previous incident asks if risk of collision exist with this ferry. How can this be determined noting her proximity and high speed?(R7d)(2)

R7d. In determining if risk of collision exists the following consideration shall be amongst those taken into account:

(i) such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change;

(ii) such risk may sometimes still exist even when a compass bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or a tow or when approaching a vessel at close range

29. On taking the second bearing, you notice the bearing is drawing slowly left but still not sure if risk of collision exist. What action does the Rule recommend if you need more time to make an assessment? (R8e)(1)

R8e. if necessary to avoid collision or allow more time to assess the situation, a vessel shall slacken her speed or take all way of by stopping or reversing her means of propulsion.

30. The ferry passes ahead at 5c and your next consideration is a MV proceeding at 8kts which you intend to overtake on the port side. What sound signals will you use and what response do you expect from her if she is in agreement?(R34c)(2)

R34c. when in sight of one another in a narrow channel or fairway:

(i) a vessel intending to overtake another shall in compliance with Rule 9(e)(i) indicate her intention by the following signals on her whistle:

- two prolonged blasts followed by one short blast to mean "I intend to overtake you on the starboard side"

- two prolonged blasts followed by two short blasts to mean "I intend to overtake you on your port side"

(ii) a vessel about to be overtaken when acting in accordance with Rule 9(e)(i) shall indicate her agreement by the following signal on her whistle:

-one prolonged, one short, one prolonged and one short blast, in that order

31. You safely overtake the MV and safely cross the TSS to your holding box overnight. As you patrol your box, you notice visibility is reducing. When do the rules for restricted visibility apply?(R19a)(1)

R19a. This Rule applies to vessels not in sight of one another when navigating in or near an area of restricted visibility

32. What sound signals would you need to be making whilst patrolling your box?(R35a)(1)

R35a. In restricted visibility, whether by day or night, the signals prescribed in this Rule shall be used as follows:

(a) A power driven vessel making way though the water shall sound at intervals of no more than 2 minutes one prolonged blast.

33. You hear apparently forward of your beam 1 prolonged followed by 2 short blasts. You cannot determine if risk of collision exists. What should be your immediate action?(R19e)(2)

R19e. Except where it has been determined that risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam, shall reduce her speed to the minimum at which she can be kept on her course. She shall if necessary take all way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until the danger of collision is over.

34. Your 200W reports a radar contact ahead at 3nm and you assess the contact ties in with the sound signal. What actions are you required to take and what must be avoided?(R19d)(2)

R19d. A vessel which detects by radar alone the presence of another vessel shall determine if a close-quarters situation is developing and/or risk of collision exists. If so, she shall take avoiding action in ample time, provided that when such action consists of an alteration of course, so far as possible the following shall be avoided:

(i) an alteration of course to port for a vessel forward of the beam, other than for a vessel being overtaken;

35. What type of contact could this be?(R35c&d)(3)

R35c. a vessel not under command, a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, a vessel constrained by her draught, a sailing vessel, a vessel engaged in fishing and a vessel engaged in towing or pushing another vessel shall, instead of the signals prescribed in paragraphs (a) or (b) of this Rule, sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts.

R35d. a vessel engaged in fishing, when at anchor, and a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre when carrying out her work at anchor, shall instead of the signals prescribe in paragraph (g) of this Rule sound the signals prescribed in paragraph (c) of this Rule.

36. You suspect the contact is a sailing vessel underway (greater than 20m). What lights will you brief your fog lookout to look out for?(R25a)(1)

R25a. a sailing vessel underway shall exhibit:

- (i) sidelights*
- (ii) a sternlight*

37. What additional lights may the sailing vessel display?(R25c)(1)

A sailing vessel underway may, in addition to the lights prescribed in paragraph (a) of this Rule, exhibit at or near the top of the mast, where they can best be seen, two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and lower green, but these lights shall not be exhibited in conjunction with the combined lantern permitted by paragraph (b) of this Rule

38. You brief the team to be on the lookout for the pilot vessel. What lights will they be looking out for if she is underway?(R29a(i)(ii))(2)

R29a(i)(ii). A vessel engaged on pilotage duty shall exhibit:

- (i) at or near the masthead, two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being white and the lower red;*
- (ii) when underway, in addition, sidelights and a sternlight*

39. You notice an outbound Bulk carrier ahead of the ship with a CPA of 1c to starboard. You report it is a head on situation. How is this defined?(R14b)(1)

R14b. ... such a situation shall be deemed to exist when a vessel sees the other ahead or nearly ahead and by night she could see both masthead lights of the other in line or nearly in line and/or both sidelights and by day she observes the corresponding aspect of the other vessel

40. What action is required from both units?(R14a)(1)

R14a. When two power driven vessels are meeting on reciprocal or nearly reciprocal courses so as to involve risk of collision each shall alter her course to starboard so that each shall pass on the port side of the other.

41. The pilot informs you that a vessel constrained by her draught is heading outbound. What must you avoid doing?(R18d)(1)

R18d(i). Any vessel other than a vessel not under command or a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre shall, of the circumstances of the case admit, avoid impeding the safe passage of a vessel constrained by her draught, exhibiting the signals in Rule 28.

42. You notice a small ferry at Green 45 lining up to cross to the other side. What does the Rule say about her actions; you can safely navigate only within the channel?(R9d)(1)

R9d. A vessel shall not cross a narrow channel or fairway if such crossing impedes the safe passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway.

43. She starts to cross and CPA is steady and does not appear to be taking action so you sound 5 short blasts. In what manner did you expect her to act as required by the circumstances of the case?(R8f(i))(1)

R8f(i). a vessel which by any of these Rules, is required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel shall, when required by the circumstances of the case, take early action to allow sufficient sea-room for the safe passage of the other vessel

44. The XO asks the YO to define a short blast. What answer will you expect if he was correct?(R32b)(1)

R32b. The term short blast means a blast of about one second's duration.

You eventually get alongside port side for a stand-easy followed by preparation for the Capability Demonstration.

Part 2	_____	/40
TOTAL	_____	/65